

**World on the brink**

Carl Jung's warnings of a need for deeper self awareness are more relevant now than ever. <https://digit.in/jul20-43>

**Persona inspiration**

The Jungian psychology concepts that inspired the demon summoning JRPG franchise, Persona. <https://digit.in/jul20-44>

MYTH AND THE PSYCHE

PART II

Exploring the subconsciousness through stories

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rchetypes and symbolism are not something very highbrow or cerebral, and are in fact quite

the opposite. It is something that we understand intuitively, even subconsciously. These are the things that make a story so appealing, which is what draws us to stories both modern and ancient, even if we do not have a conscious understanding of them. Jung's great insight was suggesting that there was a collective or shared unconsciousness, that makes up an individual's personality, as much as their ego and personal unconsciousness. The collective unconscious can be considered as a psychological inheritance, a source of the knowledge and wisdom that humans have acquired over time as a species. If you have read the books recommended in the previous article and want to learn more about how these stories relate to individuals, then the book to read is *Structure & Dynamics of the Psyche* by Carl Jung.

THE ARCHETYPES

The August 2019 Infoporn has a detailed step by step comparison of Star Wars, the Matrix, Thor and Harry Pot-



ter all going through the hero's journey as outlined by Joseph Campbell. These are the aspects that are common and essential among all these stories, and what makes them universally appealing. For example, one of these parts of the Hero's Journey is Crossing the Threshold, where the hero leaves behind the familiar world that he knows, and ventures into a world of mystery or fantasy. In Harry Potter, this is when he discovers the existence of the wizarding world, and literally happens when he enters Platform 9 and $\frac{3}{4}$. In Star Wars, both Luke Skywalker and Anakin Skywalker are taken up into space and thrown into a world full of space wizards and laser swords, from a mundane existence as a slave or a moisture farmer. In The Matrix, Neo finds out that his entire existence is a construct, and follows the White Rabbit to take the Red Pill that leads him to the truth, and the real world. Campbell explains, "The adventure is always and everywhere a passage beyond the veil of the known

into the unknown; the powers that watch at the boundary are dangerous; to deal with them is risky; yet for anyone with competence and courage the danger fades."

One of the most common tropes to appear in fiction is the hero vanquishing the dragon. The dragon is typically the number two big bad. In the Tolkien Legendarium, Bilbo takes on Smaug in *The Hobbit* before the Dark Lord, Sauron, is vanquished in *The Lord of the Rings*. One of the enduring iconographies is that of St George slaying the Dragon, a scene replicated in the Harry Potter movies when Neville Longbottom slays Nagini, the serpent of the Dark Lord, Voldemort. The dragon plays a similar role in stories both ancient and modern. In the story of Heracles, it is the Hydra while in the Lion King, the pack of Hyenas together form the Dragon. The trope can appear in chess as well, where the Queen can be considered a dragon to the King. Yes, it is obviously about good defeating evil, but on a deeper level, the dragon